

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: I've hurt my back. Do you have any suggestions?



Learning Outcome

Exchange advice and suggestions in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- Have you injured your back before?
- What can someone do to stop back pain? Ice? Medication?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about injuries, accidents and health care.
- I can write about recent actions and routines.
- I can write a short e-mail.





Let's Explore!

Sally is looking for some health advice. Vanessa suggests that she **approach*** a friend of hers who works in the health industry.

* To "approach" can mean to start talking to someone for some purpose like to ask a question or make a request.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Subject Line: Back Pain

Dear Karen,

I know this e-mail must come as a surprise to you, but our mutual friend, Vanessa Wright, suggested that I contact you. She says that you have a lot of experience with health issues as a physiotherapist. I have been looking for someone to provide me with some health advice. Despite the fact that I have been to a number of doctors since the accident, nothing seems to be working. Maybe you have been working with some new treatments or technology that can help me?

Recently, I was bowling with a friend. I fell backwards and landed on my back. My friend heard my calls for help and took me to the hospital. There was a lot of bruising and swelling and I found it hard to move. Nurses gave me some pain medication and assured me that I would be feeling much better in a couple days. I was discharged later that evening.

Unfortunately, the pain and swelling have not subsided. I am still unable to walk without pain or bend over to put on my shoes. It has been a long three weeks!

Vanessa and I have been planning a weekend visit to New York for months. It's a month away now and I have been getting more and more concerned about my situation. Could you provide me with some tips or ideas to speed up my recovery? Are there any new breakthroughs in medical technology I can try?

Kind regards,

Sally Davis





Let's Practice!

Can you give me some advice?

Instructions: Match the two parts of the sentences from Column A to Column B. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

COLUMN A

1. She says that you have a lot of experience with
2. I fell backwards and landed
3. My neighbor heard my calls for help and took
4. Nurses gave me some pain medication and assured
5. Could you provide me with some
6. There was a lot of bruising and swelling and I found
7. Despite the fact the I have been to a number
8. Are there any new breakthroughs

COLUMN B

- a. tips or ideas to speed up my recovery?
- b. me to hospital.
- c. it hard to move.
- d. health issues as a physiotherapist.
- e. in a medical technology I can try.
- f. me that I would be feeling much better in a couple days.
- g. on my back.
- h. of doctors since the accident, nothing seems to be working.



Let's Practice!

Writing about recent actions.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Complete the gaps with the proper verb and tense. Use the verbs below. The first sentence is done.

look / be / plan / not subside / get / work

1. I've been "looking for" someone to provide me with some health advice for a while.
2. It _____ a long three weeks!
3. Vanessa and I _____ a weekend visit to New York for months.
4. Unfortunately, the pain and swelling _____.
5. It's a month away now and I _____ more and more concerned about my situation.
6. Maybe you _____ with some new treatments or technology that can help me?





Extension Activity

You wrote a formal e-mail to a health professional. Now, it's time to write an informal e-mail to a friend.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write an 80-100 word informal e-mail to a friend about an accident. Choose from the following: slipping on a wet floor, injuring yourself playing a sport, or cutting yourself while cooking
- Describe the injury and your recovery.
- Include contractions and informal language.
- Use adjective to provide rich descriptions.
- Use the Present Perfect tense and the Present Perfect Continuous tense.
- Read your e-mail aloud to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I write an informal e-mail about an accident.

☐ ☐

I describe an injury and recovery.

☐ ☐

I use adjectives to provide rich descriptions.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **mutual** (adjective): shared between two or more people
e.g. Our mutual friend, Vanessa Wright, suggested that I contact you.
- **physiotherapist** (noun): a person whose job is to improve a person's movement after accident or injury
e.g. She says that you have a lot of experience with health issues as a physiotherapist.
- **to assure** (verb): to make something certain
e.g. The nurses assured me that I would be feeling much better in a couple days.
- **to discharge** (verb): to allow (someone) to leave a hospital
e.g. I was discharged later that evening.
- **to subside** (verb): to become less strong or intense
e.g. The pain and swelling has not subsided.
- **recovery** (noun): the act or process of becoming healthy after an illness or injury
e.g. Could you provide me with some tips or ideas to speed up my recovery?
- **breakthrough** (noun): a sudden increase in knowledge and understanding
e.g. Are there any new breakthroughs in medical technology that can help me?





Learning Points

Writing An E-mail To Ask For Help

Functional Language

When you write a formal e-mail, include:

- an informative subject line, which says what the e-mail is about
- the most important information first
- simple grammar
- short sentences
- formal language
- paragraphs to keep the e-mail clear and easy to understand

Present perfect continuous vs. Present perfect (+ words for duration)

You use these tenses to express that an action began in the past and is still going on or has just finished.

We use the *Present Perfect tense* mainly to express that an action is completed or to emphasise the result.

Forms:

regular Verbs: form of 'have' + base form + ed

Example: I have worked at the bakery for six years.

irregular Verbs: form of 'have' + irregular verb

Example: I have written a number of books in the last two years.

We use the *Present Perfect Continuous tense* to emphasise the duration or continuous course of an action.

Form:

form of 'have' + been + verb + ing

Example: We have been walking for two hours!

Examples:

- Vanessa and I **have been planning** a weekend visit to New York **for** months.
- It's a month away now and I **have been getting** more and more concerned about my situation.
- Despite the fact that I **have been** to a number of doctors **since** the accident, nothing seems to be working.

